



What Comes Next?

Reading a pattern that repeats

Name:

Date:

★ I can read a pattern and draw what comes next.

Patterns repeat

A pattern is a row that repeats the same way. If you know the pattern, you can tell what comes next.

Watch Bit — ▲ ■ ▲ ■ ...



It goes triangle, square, triangle, square. After ▲ comes ■. The next one is ■.

1 Draw what comes next

Read the pattern out loud, then draw the next shape in the dashed box.



2 Draw what comes next

Read the pattern, then draw the next shape in the dashed box.



3 You try — a longer pattern

This pattern goes two-then-one. Read it and draw what comes next.



Big idea

Reading a pattern lets you know what comes next. Computers follow patterns too — that is how they repeat a job the same way every time.



What Comes Next?

Quick facilitation notes & answer key

What this worksheet teaches

Children read a repeating shape pattern and draw the next shape. Reading and continuing a pattern is a first thinking-skill behind coding — it is how computers repeat a job the same way every time. No coding experience needed.

Before you start (no computer needed)

No computer — paper and a pencil or crayon. You read each prompt aloud; the child draws the next shape. Optional: pattern blocks or beads to build the pattern by hand first.

How to lead it (about 15 minutes)

1. Show them (you do). Point and say the pattern aloud — "triangle, square, triangle, square..." The next is a square.
2. Do one together. Exercise 1 — say circle, star, circle, star, circle aloud; the next is a star.
3. Let them try. Children do Exercise 2, then Exercise 3 (the two-then-one pattern) on their own.

Answer key (these are the verified correct answers)

Exercise 1 — circle, star, circle, star, circle → next is a star. Exercise 2 — square, triangle, square, triangle → next is a square.

Exercise 3 — star, star, circle, star, star, circle → next is a star (the pattern is star, star, circle, repeating).

If children get stuck — and ways to adjust

Watch for: copying the last shape shown. Have them say the whole pattern aloud first.

Make it easier: build the pattern with real blocks and add the next one by hand.

Make it harder: ask the child to keep the pattern going for two or three more shapes.

Make it active: clap–stomp–clap–stomp and ask what movement comes next.

Ontario Kindergarten link (official wording)

Problem Solving and Innovating — children identify, reproduce, and extend repeating patterns.

In plain terms: spotting a repeating pattern and saying what comes next.

No reading is needed from the child — you read each prompt aloud; the child answers by drawing or circling.

You'll know it worked when

The child says the repeating part aloud and draws the correct next shape for each pattern.